

Inversion**Part 1: Proofreading quiz**

Each sentence contains TWO errors. Proofread the sentences.

1. Social media connects people instantly which make the world feel smaller.
2. Online courses are ideal for busy adults, especially those which has little time to attend classes.
3. There are dozens of messaging apps, all of them is free to use.
4. The forums which students share their homework is very popular.
5. Many teenagers spend hours gaming, that worry their parents.
6. Not only the internet connects people around the world, but it also spreads information quickly.

Part 2: Three patterns for formal writing

The three patterns in this part all follow the same rule: the auxiliary verb (or the verb 'be') moves before the subject. Each pattern can lift a formal paragraph towards a higher band.

Pattern 1: Not only ... but also ...

Structure:	Not only + auxiliary + subject + verb, but (subject) also + verb
Use in formal writing:	Adds a second advantage in proposals, reports and articles.
Example:	Not only does the scheme save money, but it also builds students' confidence.

Introducing a school e-learning platform would bring clear benefits. Not only does the platform give students round-the-clock access to learning materials, but it also allows teachers to track progress more closely. With such a system, revision becomes a habit rather than a scramble before exams.

Pattern 2: Never / Rarely / Seldom

Structure:	Never / Rarely / Seldom + auxiliary + subject + verb
Use in formal writing:	Makes a criticism or a claim sound stronger and more formal.
Example:	Rarely do we question our daily screen habits.

Many parents blame video games for every poor result. Rarely do they stop to consider how limited their children's other entertainment options are. The real problem may be the lack of balance, not the games themselves.

Pattern 3: Only by ...

Structure:	Only by + -ing / noun phrase + auxiliary + subject + verb
Use in formal writing:	Sets a condition that leads to a result — ideal for conclusions and recommendations.
Example:	Only by upgrading the campus network can the school offer reliable online lessons.

Working from home has become common in many industries. Only by investing in secure networks and clear communication tools can companies keep their teams productive. Technology can help, but good management matters more.

Part 3: Practice sets

Rewrite each simple sentence using the pattern given in the prompt. The sentences are all about technology and communication, so keep the register formal. The even-numbered sets (2, 4 and 6) are more challenging.

Example Set 1 (Not only ... but also ...)

Simple sentence:	The online platform saves paper, and it gives students instant feedback.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Not only' to add a second advantage.</i>

Example Set 2 (Not only ... but also ...)

Simple sentence:	The workshop improved students' digital skills, and it boosted their confidence in online presentations.
Prompt:	Use 'Not only ... but also ...' to combine the workshop's two benefits.

Example Set 3 (Never / Rarely / Seldom)

Simple sentence:	Readers do not often verify news sources before sharing them.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Rarely'.</i>

Example Set 4 (Never / Rarely / Seldom)

Simple sentence:	Teenagers often go to sleep without turning off their notifications, which leads to hours of late-night scrolling.
Prompt:	Begin with 'Seldom'.

Example Set 5 (Only by ...)

Simple sentence:	Schools can protect students' privacy if they issue clear guidelines on social media use.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Only by'.</i>

Example Set 6 (Only by ...)

Simple sentence:	If we want to fight online scams, governments should work closely with technology companies.
Prompt:	Begin with 'Only by'.

Part 4: Writing Task

Instructions:

- Social media plays a big part in students' lives. Write ONE paragraph (about 60 words) giving your view on whether students should limit their use of social media.
- Use ONE inversion and ONE relative clause.
